

Is your PC drowning in leftover clutter, for instance? Click Modules > Clean up system and you'll find links to delete unnecessary files, fix Registry problems, or clear your browser cache file, history and cookies.

Is speed the problem? Choose the Optimize Performance module, defragment your hard disk, take control of your startup programs or disable unnecessary services.

And if you don't think Windows is set up correctly, then look no further than the Tune system settings module. It's packed with tweaks for Control Panel, Explorer, Windows Media Player, Microsoft Office, Outlook, Firefox and more.

If you prefer an easier life, then select the Overview tab and click Full Scan. WinOptimizer 2009 will examine your PC's configuration and report on any problems, then you can fix them all in one go just by clicking the Start Optimization button.

System requirements: Windows 2000/XP/Vista, 40MB hard disk space

Contact: www.ashampoo.com

Need to know: Leave 'Get full version key' checked during installation to register the program. Upgrade to Ashampoo WinOptimizer 5 and you'll gain a file undelete tool, real-time backup program and Registry Optimizer, while all the cleanup tools can now be launched from a Windows Vista Sidebar Gadget. The list price is Rs.2,125, but as a registered user you can upgrade for only Rs.530. Click Internet > Upgrade to order.

vLite 1.2

Free up memory and computer resources by creating a custom version of Windows Vista

Windows Vista requires lots of memory and computer resources to run properly, and so often performs poorly on older PCs or notebooks. One reason for this is the operating system now comes with so many applets, components and services that less powerful computers just can't cope, but there is a possible solution. vLite 1.2 creates a custom Windows Vista installation DVD that removes all the components you don't need, so reducing

memory requirements and improving your PC speed.

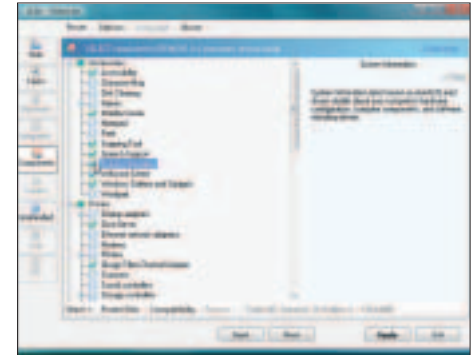
Do you never use applets like Paint, for instance? If not, get rid of them. You don't have an Xbox, a Windows Mobile device, a TV tuner? If not, and you're sure you won't buy them in future, then there's no need to keep the hardware support. And Windows Vista also comes with plenty of components that you'll probably never miss. If you've installed your own backup tool and firewall, for instance, then do you really need Windows own versions? vLite can remove those, too.

The results can be impressive, freeing up lots of Ram and delivering much better PC speeds, but there's also a price. You must reinstall Vista to see any benefit (vLite can't work with the current installation), and if you remove something you need later then another reinstall will be necessary.

System requirements: Windows Vista, 7MB hard disk space

Contact: www.vlite.net

Need to know: Check the busy vLite forum for help and advice on using the program (www.vlite.net)



Desktops 1.0

Four virtual desktops allow you to organise numerous open applications more efficiently

If you're running four or five programs on the Windows Vista desktop then it's easy to switch between them. Just click an application window, use Flip3D or select a button on the taskbar. But what if you need to run 10 programs, 15, maybe 20? Now the taskbar buttons are too small to read, Flip3D is a mess, and even Alt+Tab won't quickly get you to the application you need.